against the 969 Movement than younger monks. Sitagu Sayadaw, a senior monk who was imprisoned in 1988, has, for example, criticised those advocating violence and spoken out in favour of interreligious peace initiatives.[107]

International politics since 2010

There has been an important international dimension to Myanmar's domestic politics since 2010. In particular, the regime has gained much from appearing to allow a democratic transition and to accept the NLD as a democratic alternative. This has seen EU sanctions lifted, other sanctions reduced and a massive influx of foreign investment.

Post-2010, Myanmar's international links have expanded, but in essence the focus has continued to be on trade rather than significant political engagement with the outside world. Capital inflows have increased from $320m in 2009–10 to $1.42bn in 2012–13, and then to an estimated $5bn in 2014–15.[108] The largest share of this investment is in telecommunications, followed by oil and gas, real estate and tourism. In addition to this massive expansion of much-needed investment, the current regime benefits from the lifting of sanctions and a generally positive international reputation. And it is reaping the economic dividends—though the benefits are going to the military rulers, not the bulk of the population.

However, even with states like India and China, tensions remain. India has concerns about the security of the poorly delineated border between the two countries,[109] and has taken in a number of Rohingya refugees. India was active in Burma even before 2007, primarily building infrastructure and in terms of oil and gas extraction.[110] However, it now has concerns that the repression in Rakhine threatens the security of the region around the Bay of Bengal. To India, Myanmar is a major trading opportunity, and it hopes that a successful transition to democracy will ease a number of problems, but Myanmar also continues to be a theatre for India's ongoing dispute with China[111] as both powers tussle for trading dominance.

China, while essentially supportive of the regime, wishes to see the conflicts in the northern provinces ended, in part to ease the creation of communication links, but also to reduce the flow of refugees into China.[112] In pursuit of this goal, China has effectively become a part of the events